

S8UL finds answer in question mark for EWC 2026

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Indian esports organisation S8UL has signed Europe, the Middle-East and Africa's (EMEA) leading PUBG: BATTLEGROUNDS roster, Team Question Mark (QM), as part of a broader multi-title qualification drive for the Esports World Cup (EWC) 2026. The announcement follows S8UL's re-selection as a Club Partner by the Esports Foundation (EF) and comes weeks after the inaugural Esports Nations Cup (ENC) lineup was confirmed. S8UL, which had roped in EA FC star Jonas Wirth before last edition's EWC, has now signed QM, formerly with BetBoom Esports — a prominent European side for the EWC this time around.

Team QM won PUBG Continental Series 7 Europe 2022 and PUBG Global Series 8 in 2025, finished top-three at PUBG Global Series 2 (2023), and reached top-seven at the PUBG Global Championship 2022.

The roster has competed at both prior EWC editions (2024 and 2025) and has accumulated roughly USD 713,000 in total prize winnings.

Captain Roman Zinovev (ADOUZ1E) will lead the lineup, which includes Andrey Ionov, Mansur Tsimpaev, Nikita Odobesku, and coach Yermek Torebekov.

"As a team, we've always believed in our ability to compete with the best in the world, and having the backing of a global organisation allows us to push even further," Zinovev, who is also a PUBG Nations Cup winner in 2019, said.

"With the Esports World Cup coming up, we're focused on working through the qualifiers and making sure we deliver performances that match our potential."

S8UL will attempt to qualify across 13 titles at EWC 2026: Apex Legends, Battlegrounds Mobile India (BGMI), Call of Duty: Warzone, Chess, EA Sports FC, FATAL Fury,

Fortnite, Honor of Kings, MOBA Legends 5V5, PUBG: BATTLEGROUNDS, Street Fighter 6, TEKKEN 8, and Trackmania. The organisation has built early momentum this year: its BGMI roster won the India Series 2026, its MOBA Legends 5v5 team took the Rai Star x Gyan Gaming Cup, Grandmaster Nihal Sarin won the Menorca Open, and its VALORANT roster claimed VCSA Split 1. The organisation's Apex Legends team recorded a top-five finish at the ALGS Championship—the best result by an Indian club in that title. EWC 2026 is scheduled between July 6 and August 23 in Riyadh and has a \$75 million prize pool.

The EWC Foundation has further confirmed the 16-title line-up for the Esports Nations Cup 2026, a nation-based competition making its debut in Riyadh between November 2 and 29.



Titles include CS2, Dota 2, League of Legends, VALORANT, PUBG: BATTLEGROUNDS, and mobile titles like PUBG MOBILE and Honor of Kings. More than 100,000 players

across 100 nations are expected to compete in hundreds of qualifiers.

NODWIN Gaming has been named India's National Team Partner, tasked with running nationwide qualifiers, forming teams, and coordinating coaches.

The ENC carries a \$45 million funding commitment, with a \$20 million prize pool distributed equally per player and coach: \$50,000 for first place, \$30,000 for second, and \$15,000 for third per title.